

HIDDEN GEMS

A YouTube Discovery Platform Initiative

Supporting Artifacts

Hidden Gems — Niche Creator Discovery Platform

Glossary · RACI · Traceability Matrix · Data Dictionary · Risk Register

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Document Control

Revision History

Version	Date	Author	Description of Change
0.1	2026-07-05	Business Analyst	Initial compilation of supporting artifacts
1.0	2026-07-14	Business Analyst	Baselined alongside BRD/FTRD v1.0

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1. Glossary of Terms

Term	Definition
Hidden Gem	A video from a mid-tier creator that has been verified-labeled and is eligible for surfacing on the Hidden Gems discovery surface.
Mid-tier creator	A YouTube creator with between 1,000 and 500,000 subscribers, the target creator segment for this initiative.
High-intent viewer	A viewer averaging more than one hour per day on YouTube who actively seeks niche content.
Label / Niche descriptor	A creator-authored, AI-verified tag describing the niche or subject matter of a video (e.g., "cinematography," "chess").
Taxonomy	The governed, versioned list of approved niche labels against which submitted labels are validated.
Label affinity	A ranking signal representing how closely a viewer's preferences match a given label.
North Star Metric	The single measurable outcome the program is accountable for: incremental daily visits gained by creators featured in Hidden Gems.
Attribution window	The defined time period after a Hidden Gems impression during which a downstream event (visit, subscribe, revenue) is credited to the surface.
MoSCoW	Prioritization technique classifying requirements as Must have, Should have, Could have, or Won't have (this release).
INVEST	Criteria for a well-formed user story: Independent, Negotiable, Valuable, Estimable, Small, Testable.
p95 latency	The response time below which 95% of requests complete; used as the platform's performance guardrail.
RACI	Responsibility assignment matrix: Responsible, Accountable, Consulted, Informed.
RTM	Requirements Traceability Matrix, mapping business objectives through to test conditions.

2. RACI Matrix

R = Responsible, A = Accountable, C = Consulted, I = Informed.

Activity	Product Mgmt	Eng. (Creator Studio)	Eng. (Recs Platform)	Trust & Safety	Data/ Analytics	Legal
Define business requirements (BRD)	A/R	C	C	C	C	I
Define functional/technical requirements (FTRD)	C	A/R	R	C	C	I
Build labeling workflow	C	A/R	I	C	I	I
Build AI label verification model	I	C	C	A/R	R	I
Build ranking/recommendation engine	C	I	A/R	I	R	I
Define & approve label taxonomy	R	C	C	A	I	C
Build attribution & analytics	C	I	C	I	A/R	I
Moderation & policy enforcement	I	I	I	A/R	I	C
Go-to-market phasing decisions	A/R	C	C	C	C	I
Legal / privacy / compliance review	C	I	I	C	I	A/R

3. Requirements Traceability Matrix (RTM)

Full end-to-end traceability from business objective to test condition. FR references correspond to the FTRD; US references correspond to the User Stories backlog; UC references correspond to the Use Case Specifications.

Objective	BR	FR(s)	User Story	Use Case	Sample Test Condition
BO-01	BR-01	FR-M1-01-06	US-101-104	UC-01	Verify a creator can add ≥ 1 label and video becomes Hidden Gems eligible upon approval
BO-06	BR-02	FR-M2-01-05	US-201-204	UC-03, UC-07	Verify labels below confidence threshold route to moderation queue
BO-01, BO-03	BR-03	FR-M3-01-05	US-301-304	UC-04, UC-09	Verify Hidden Gems section renders on home tab with correct chips and cards
BO-01, BO-03	BR-04	FR-M4-01-03	US-401-402	UC-05, UC-09	Verify search by label term returns badged Hidden Gems results
BO-01, BO-03	BR-05	FR-M6-01-02	US-501-502	UC-06	Verify watch page shows Featured badge and related-gems modules
BO-01, BO-04	BR-06	FR-M6-03-04	US-503-504	UC-02, UC-06	Verify tapping creator name from a Gem navigates to profile
BO-01, BO-04	BR-07	FR-M7-01-04	US-601-604	UC-10	Verify a visit within the attribution window is tagged source = hidden_gems
BO-05, BO-06	BR-08	— (program-level)	—	—	Verify phased rollout gating criteria are enforced before advancing phases
BO-04	BR-09	FR-M7-03	US-603	UC-08	Verify dashboard shows accurate views/CTR/revenue for selected date range
BO-06	BR-10	NFR-01-10	—	—	Verify uptime, latency, precision, and relevance guardrails under load test

4. Data Dictionary

Entity	Attribute	Type	Description / Constraints
Label	label_id	UUID	Primary key, system-generated
Label	taxonomy_ref	String	Foreign key to approved Taxonomy entry; null if custom/pending
Label	display_text	String (≤ 40 chars)	Human-readable label shown to viewers
Label	status	Enum	pending approved rejected needs_review suspended
Label	created_by	creator_id (FK)	Creator who submitted the label
Video-Label Association	video_id	UUID (FK)	References the video entity
Video-Label Association	label_id	UUID (FK)	References the Label entity
Video-Label Association	verification_score	Decimal (0-1)	AI confidence score at time of verification
Video-Label Association	verified_at	Timestamp	UTC; null until verification completes
Viewer Preference Profile	viewer_id	UUID (FK)	References the viewer account
Viewer Preference Profile	affinity_vector	Vector (float[])	Derived embedding representing label affinities
Viewer Preference Profile	opted_labels	Array[label_id]	Labels explicitly selected via chips
Discovery Impression	impression_id	UUID	Primary key, system-generated
Discovery Impression	surface	Enum	home search watch_page profile
Discovery Impression	rank_position	Integer	1-indexed position within the surfaced list
Attribution Event	event_type	Enum	visit subscribe ad_revenue membership superchat
Attribution Event	value	Decimal	Monetary value for revenue event types; null otherwise
Attribution Event	attributed_at	Timestamp	UTC; time the event was credited to Hidden Gems

5. Risk Register

ID	Risk Description	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation / Owner
R-01	Poor viewer adoption of the Hidden Gems surface	Medium	High	In-product marketing plus rolling viewer surveys to iterate quickly. Owner: Product Management
R-02	Regional irrelevance of surfaced content in certain markets	Medium	Medium	Demographic-based surfacing with feedback-driven rotation. Owner: Discovery & Recs Team
R-03	Algorithm fails to reliably surface niche creators	Medium	High	Continuous A/B testing and real-time behavioral audits. Owner: Recommendations Engineering
R-04	Label spam or abuse by bad actors undermines trust	Medium	High	AI verification with 90% precision target plus human review escalation. Owner: Trust & Safety
R-05	Insufficient labeled creator supply at viewer launch	Low	High	Sequenced closed beta to build supply before viewer rollout. Owner: Product Management
R-06	Latency/performance guardrail breach at scale	Low	Medium	Load testing against NFR-01/02 prior to each phase gate. Owner: Engineering
R-07	Regulatory scrutiny of algorithmic fairness / labeling practices	Low	Medium	Early legal/policy review; transparent labeling criteria. Owner: Legal
R-08	Advertiser extension (Phase 4) dilutes organic discovery quality	Low	Medium	Maintain separation between organic ranking and sponsored placement; monitor relevance guardrail. Owner: Product Management

6. Assumptions & Constraints Log

ID	Type	Statement	Status
A-01	Assumption	Creators will invest time labeling content given a demonstrable reach uplift (~3×).	Open
A-02	Assumption	Sufficient labeled supply can be built during closed beta before viewer rollout.	Open
A-03	Assumption	Existing ranking infrastructure can be extended without full re-architecture.	Validated
A-04	Assumption	Existing viewer preference/watch-history data is sufficient to power initial ranking.	Validated
CN-01	Constraint	Solution must operate within existing content policy, privacy, and regional compliance frameworks.	Fixed
CN-02	Constraint	AI label verification must meet $\geq 90\%$ precision before any rollout beyond beta.	Fixed
CN-03	Constraint	Platform guardrails: $\geq 99\%$ uptime at peak, p95 latency $< 400\text{ms}$.	Fixed
CN-04	Constraint	Phase 2+ funding is contingent on Phase 1 beta success criteria.	Fixed

7. Business Impact Model — Assumptions

The following back-of-the-envelope assumptions, sourced from the originating product case study, underpin the Phase 2 (viewer rollout) sizing referenced in the BRD.

- If 10% of the target high-intent viewer segment discovers at least one new creator via Hidden Gems, YouTube unlocks a meaningful new volume of daily creator profile visits.
- Sizing inputs: total YouTube daily active users, the addressable target viewer segment, and the addressable mid-tier creator population (1K–500K subscribers).
- These figures should be re-validated against current platform data before Phase 2 investment sign-off; the case study's presentation-level figures are directional, not audited.

8. Competitive Landscape Reference

Platform	Discoverability Investment
TikTok	Deep analytics for creator strategy
Instagram	Explore algorithm surfaces new creators
Twitch	Advanced tagging for niche discovery
LinkedIn	Highlights thought leaders per industry

9. Quick-Reference: Non-Functional Guardrails

Guardrail	Target	Monitored By
Uptime during peak	≥ 99%	Site Reliability Engineering
p95 latency	< 400 ms	Engineering / Performance QA
AI label precision	≥ 90%	Trust & Safety / ML Ops
Recommendation relevance	≥ 85%	Data Science / Recommendations Team

10. Related Documents

- Business Requirements Document (BRD) — Hidden Gems, v1.0
- Functional & Technical Requirements Document (FTRD) — Hidden Gems, v1.0
- User Stories & Agile Backlog — Hidden Gems, v1.0
- Process Maps — Hidden Gems, v1.0
- Use Case Specifications — Hidden Gems, v1.0